

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Hema Vishnu

Address: 125 Gander Green Lane Sutton SM1 2EU

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: Formal Objection

I wish to formally object to the above application on the following material planning grounds:

1. Highway Safety and Parking Pressure

The proposal does not appear to provide sufficient on-site parking to accommodate the anticipated level of use. This is highly likely to result in overspill parking into surrounding residential streets, which are already constrained in width and capacity.

Of particular concern is the proximity of a large primary school in the immediate area, with over 1,500 pupils. The surrounding roads are already heavily congested with significant vehicle movements, parents parking on surrounding streets, and high pedestrian activity. Many School staff park on these nearby roads as well, keeping the parking spaces nearly occupied at all times. So there is not much room for extra parking. Many parents attend with young children and buggies, and some older children walk home independently.

Additional overspill parking and increased vehicle movements associated with this proposal would further reduce visibility at junctions, restrict safe crossing points, and significantly increase risk to children and families. The cumulative impact of school-run congestion combined with new peak-time demand would materially worsen highway safety conditions.

2. Peak-Time Congestion and Pedestrian Safety

The proposed use is expected to generate concentrated traffic flows during peak periods, including evenings and weekends, which may overlap with school activities and local traffic patterns. The surrounding road network already experiences congestion and informal parking during peak school hours.

The combination of increased traffic, reduced road capacity due to overspill parking, and high pedestrian footfall - particularly involving children and families - creates a serious pedestrian safety concern. The intensification of vehicle movements in an area already under pressure raises clear risks for vulnerable road users.

Parking occurs on both sides of the road, which operates as a two-way traffic route, significantly narrowing the carriageway. As a result, buses and other vehicles have considerable difficulty manoeuvring between parked cars, frequently creating bottlenecks around junctions and contributing to congestion and safety concerns.

The addition of further vehicles parking on these already constrained roads will only exacerbate the existing congestion and increase risks to other road users, particularly vulnerable pedestrians such as young children and elderly residents.

3. Impact on Residential Amenity

The scale and intensity of the proposed use may result in increased noise, disturbance, vehicle movements, and activity levels extending into evenings. This would alter the quiet residential character of the area and negatively affect neighbouring residents' living conditions.

4. Emergency Vehicle Access

Overspill parking and congestion may obstruct access for emergency vehicles. Given the constrained nature of surrounding roads and existing peak-time congestion, there is a genuine risk that emergency services could face delays, which is a significant public safety concern.

5. Reliance on Management Measures

The proposal appears to rely heavily on management plans and behavioural controls to mitigate its impacts. Such measures are difficult to monitor and enforce over the long term. Planning decisions should be based on sustainable, built-in design solutions rather than reliance on ongoing operational management to address fundamental capacity and safety issues.

For the reasons outlined above, I believe the proposal would result in unacceptable impacts on highway safety, pedestrian safety, residential amenity, and emergency access, and therefore should be refused.